

THE WRITTEN PROJECT — HOW THE WHOLE THING FITS TOGETHER

Cyber.SoHo Educational Hub

Management of Information Systems (IS) Assessment

Read this once, now, before you start Task 01. It takes five minutes and it will change how you approach the next three weeks.

1. THERE IS ONLY ONE PIECE OF WORK

Look at the Course Evaluation Table and you will see two entries that both say thirty percent: **"Continuous Course Assessments"** and **"Written Project"**.

They are the same thirty percent. Not sixty. One body of work, marked in three instalments as you build it.

The Written Project	One document — <i>The IS Assessment Dossier</i>
Built from	Three tasks, worth 10% each
Total weight	30% of the final grade
Final submission	Midnight CET, Friday 28 August 2026

The reason it is structured this way is simple and it is in your favour: you get corrective feedback **twice** before the version that counts. Most students improve their final mark by several points purely by acting on the Task 01 feedback in Task 02. The ones who do not read it are the ones who hand in the same mistakes three times.

2. THE RULE THAT MAKES IT A CAPSTONE

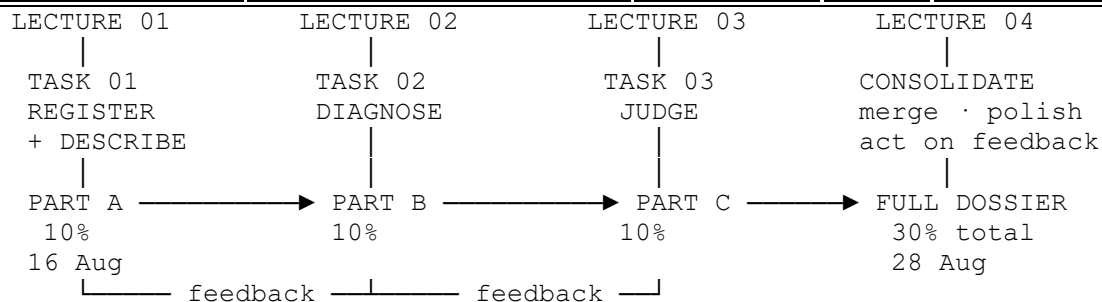
One subject. Three passes.

You choose **one organisation** and **one system** in Task 01, and you keep both until 28 August. Tasks 02 and 03 go deeper into the same subject. **You cannot switch.**

Choose carefully in Task 01. A subject with at least three roles involved, one complete cycle you can observe in under thirty minutes, and something you can count will carry you comfortably through all three tasks. A subject chosen because it sounds impressive will not.

3. THE FOUR LECTURES, THE THREE TASKS

Lecture	Task	Produces	Weight	Due
01 — IS in the Digital Age	Task 01 — <i>Baseline Assessment</i>	Part A	10%	Sun 16 Aug, midnight CET
02	Task 02 (<i>briefed in that lecture</i>)	Part B	10%	announced in Lecture 02
03	Task 03 (<i>briefed in that lecture</i>)	Part C	10%	announced in Lecture 03
04	<i>no new task</i> — consolidation workshop	The full dossier	—	Fri 28 Aug, midnight CET



The twelve days between 16 and 28 August are not spare time. They are when Tasks 02 and 03 happen, and when you rewrite Part A using what the feedback told you.

4. WHAT EACH PASS DOES

Part A — DESCRIBE (*Task 01, this week*)

Establish what the system **is**: its four activities, its three dimensions, one business process mapped across departments, a competitive-forces scorecard with evidence beside every score, and an ethics review. Ends with your six-lens baseline, an evidence log, and the questions you could not answer.

This is the foundation. Everything later either builds on it or corrects it.

Part B — DIAGNOSE (*Task 02, provisional shape*)

Go beneath the surface of the same system: its data, its integration with other systems, where information is duplicated or lost, and what the handoffs actually cost. You will close some of the open questions you wrote in A7.

Part C — JUDGE (*Task 03, provisional shape*)

Reach a defensible position. Recommend a change, cost it in something other than money, name what would have to be true for you to be wrong, and say how you would measure whether the change worked.

Parts B and C are described here so you can see where you are heading. The binding briefs arrive with Lectures 02 and 03 and may differ in detail. Part A will not change.

5. WHAT THE FINAL DOSSIER LOOKS LIKE

One PDF, roughly 5,000–6,500 words of prose plus tables and figures.

COVER	name · student number · subject organisation and system	
EXECUTIVE SUMMARY	one page, written LAST · the assessment in ~350 words	
CONTENTS	· your single strongest finding · your weakest lens	
PART A	Baseline Assessment	(Task 01, revised)
PART B	Diagnosis	(Task 02, revised)
PART C	Judgement and Recommendation	(Task 03, revised)
REFLECTION	~400 words · what you got wrong in Part A and how you know · what you would do differently with another month	
APPENDICES	consolidated evidence log · all figures · all scorecards · full source list	

Two things exist **only** in the final version, and both are marked:

- **The executive summary** — written last, read first. One page. If a busy reader reads nothing else, this has to be enough.
 - **The reflection** — a genuine account of what you got wrong earlier and how you found out. Not a thank-you note. Students who write an honest reflection score well; students who write "I learned a lot about information systems" do not.
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6. HOW THE MARKS WORK

Each task is marked out of 100 and scaled to 10%. The final dossier is not marked again from scratch — it is marked on **consolidation**: whether you acted on feedback, whether the three parts read as one document instead of three homeworks stapled together, and whether the executive summary and reflection do their jobs.

The six lenses govern all of it:

Lens	Question	Weight
1. Purpose	Which business objectives does the system serve?	×1
2. People	Who inputs, who decides, who is affected?	×1
3. Process	Which steps does it change, remove or create?	×1
4. Strategy	Which competitive force does it weaken?	×1
5. Ethics	Whose data, whose risk, whose accountability?	×2
6. Evidence	What measurement proves each claim is true?	×2

And the four rules that never change:

1. A lens you skip is a mark you lose. All six, every time.
2. Ethics and Evidence carry double weight.
3. **A score with no written finding scores zero.** Not reduced — zero.
4. **Report the weakest lens, not the average.** Averaging hides the thing you were asked to find.

7. PRACTICAL THINGS THAT WILL SAVE YOU

- **Keep every version.** Name files with dates. When you revise Part A in week four you will want to see what you originally wrote, and the reflection is much easier if you can.
 - **Keep the evidence log running from day one.** Do not rebuild it at the end. It is double-weighted, it takes minutes if you maintain it, and hours if you do not.
 - **Write your open questions honestly.** Task 02 largely consists of answering them. A dishonest A7 makes your own next task harder.
 - **The rules of engagement apply for the whole term,** not only during Task 01. Observe as an ordinary user, collect no personal data, test nothing, publish nothing.
 - **Know your clock.** Midnight CET on 28 August is roughly **Friday afternoon in Montréal.** Work it out now. Submit a day early — the DropBox accepts replacements, so an early upload costs you nothing and protects you from everything.
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8. THE DEADLINES, IN ONE PLACE

What	When	Where
Task 01 — Part A	Midnight CET, Sunday 16 August 2026	Blackboard → Assignments → DropBox
Task 02 — Part B	announced in Lecture 02	Blackboard → Assignments → DropBox
Task 03 — Part C	announced in Lecture 03	Blackboard → Assignments → DropBox
FULL WRITTEN PROJECT	Midnight CET, Friday 28 August 2026	Blackboard → Assignments → DropBox

Emailed submissions are not submissions. If something serious happens in your life, tell me **before** a deadline rather than after it — what I can do before midnight is a great deal more than what I can do afterwards, and you do not owe me an explanation to ask.

*All tools, formats and techniques named across this project are examples only. They are **open and fully substitutable** — research your own, compare at least two, and build your own where nothing fits. Scan every external link you meet in the course materials through [VirusTotal — https://www.virustotal.com/gui/home/url](https://www.virustotal.com/gui/home/url) before opening it. All case studies used in the course materials are entirely fictional. This is educational material, not legal, privacy, compliance or professional advice. The rules of engagement and the full disclaimer, copyright, academic-integrity and lawful-conduct notices in section 16 of the Task 01 exercise document apply to every task in this project and form part of the assessment requirements.*